the state. These things cannot come through dynastic and casteist politics.

Q. Why then does a section of OBC leaders insist that the party pays only lip service to their interests?
I would say our schemes speak for themselves. The 43 lakh houses that have been given have not gone to my relatives, I am a single person. These have been given to the Dalits, backwards and poor in the state. These issues are being raised by those who have had the ground shift beneath their feet and have been completely decimated by the public.

Q. Casteism seems to have made a return in politics. Hindutva is one thing but casteism seems to be becoming a decisive factor in ticket distribution. Isn't the BJP doing it too?
Caste is a factor in winning elections, but the BJP had contested elections on the issues of nationalism, development and good governance and it will continue to do so going forward.

Q. But you have allied with the Apna Dal, Nishad Party etc.
They have been our allies in the past and we will continue to do so out of respect for our past association.

Q. You talked of 80 versus 20 per cent in a recent interview. Is it an attempt to polarise communities?
It does not refer to polarisation. This is about constructive politics—the election will be 80 versus 20. You will see that the BJP will clinch 80 per cent seats; we will have 80 per cent popular support, be it the village, the poor, the farmers, the youth, the women, the intellectual...those who want to move ahead with constructive politics, those who want the state to prosper and be safe, those who are interested in the development of youth, women's safety, and infrastructure development. All such people will vote for the BJP. Those who favour the mafia, endorse goondaism, incite riots and anarchy will vote for the other side.



"It was the BJP that put an end to the triple talaq menace. Are Muslim women not entitled to justice? When we allotted houses, did we check whether the beneficiary was Hindu or Muslim? Everyone benefits equally from all schemes"

Q. Your statement was seen as referring to Muslims...
It was the BJP that put an end to the menace of triple talaq. Are Muslim women not entitled to justice? When we allotted houses, did we check whether the beneficiary was Hindu or Muslim? Everyone benefits equally from all schemes.

Q. But Muslims comprise 20 per cent of the population. How many tickets will you give them?
We have not talked about caste or votebank at all. For us, a person's merit will lie in his or her winning potential, regardless of caste, region or community. Whoever applies for a ticket will